



PUCCINI'S HOUSE IN TUSCANY

The composer's house in Lucca, now a museum, had been in his family since 1815 and is where he spent his childhood. On display here, among other things, are family photos and one of his pianos.

Final days

Ill with diabetes, living in a post-war Italy where he no longer felt at home, Puccini applied himself with fanatical determination to writing *Turandot*, his final work. Diagnosed with cancer of the throat, in 1924 he went to Belgium for radium treatment. Before leaving, he appealed to Toscanini to ensure that *Turandot* would be performed after his death. Appallingly painful and quite useless, the treatment killed him. The composer was accorded a state funeral in Milan, with the funeral oration delivered by Italy's new fascist leader, Benito Mussolini. *Turandot*, left unfinished, was completed from Puccini's sketches by Italian